

Bram Norwood

Character Dossier

Quietly ambitious spymaster of the Academy of Vell

Overview

Bram Norwood is a spymaster living in the Academy of Vell. Bram is 65 years old, originally from the Mirefold, and is known around the Hall of Echoes as quietly ambitious. In conversation Bram speaks softly and expects people to lean in.

Background

Bram arrived in the Academy of Vell 28 years ago after leaving the Mirefold under circumstances Bram describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Faculty of Applied Wonders; the second was the one that stuck. Today Bram works as a spymaster near the north observatory and is paid, when paid at all, in guilders.

Bram learned the trade from Phaedra Corvane, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Bram's life is with Wren Corvane, over a matter neither will explain. The person Bram trusts most is Percival Norwood.

Current goal: to be trusted by the Faculty of Applied Wonders again. Greatest fear: running out of salt.

Personality and speech

Temperament: quietly ambitious.

Speech pattern: Bram speaks softly and expects people to lean in.

Tells: when lying, Bram mentions Tinker the tortoise for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Bram Norwood
Role	spymaster
Home	the Academy of Vell
Hometown	the Mirefold
Age	65
Favourite dish	grandmother's cold buckwheat noodles
Pet	Tinker, a tortoise
Lucky number	185

<i>Workshop password</i>	birch-granite
<i>Mentor</i>	Phaedra Corvane
<i>Rival</i>	Wren Corvane
<i>Closest friend</i>	Percival Norwood

Secret

Bram once turned down an offer from the Faculty of Applied Wonders that would have made them rich, and wonders about it nightly.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Bram: I am the spymaster. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Bram: Grandmother's cold buckwheat noodles. Do not tell Wren I said so.

Visitor: Is Tinker yours?

Bram: Tinker belongs to nobody. Tinker tolerates me. Lucky number is 185, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 4

Bram won 88 guilders from Wren on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on grandmother's cold buckwheat noodles. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Bram suspects Percival and is probably right. Bram closed early, walked to the greenhouse cloisters, and watched the lights come on. Tinker followed at a distance.

Entry 2, spring of year 4

the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the missing shipment. Bram read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Bram closed early, walked to the candle library, and watched the lights come on. Tinker followed at a distance. A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Bram and Wren outside the bell tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 3, summer of year 4

Bram spent the day counting stock at the greenhouse cloisters: 6 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Bram suspects Percival and is probably right. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Bram repaired the hand bell at the greenhouse cloisters for Anouk, who paid in 67 guilders and a long story about the quarantine. Bram won 30 guilders from Wren on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on grandmother's cold buckwheat noodles.

Entry 4, autumn of year 4

At the Hall of Echoes, Bram taught Percival how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Vesna came by asking about the old tunnels. Bram said nothing useful and made tea instead. Bram repaired the grain scale at the Hall of Echoes for Amadou, who paid in 6 guilders and a long story about who really won the regatta.

Entry 5, winter of year 4

The weather turned. Bram moved the oilskin map indoors, fed Tinker, and wrote three lines to Phaedra about the tariff on salt. The weather turned. Bram moved the copper pipe indoors, fed Tinker, and wrote three lines to Phaedra about whether the bridge will hold. Rumours about the harvest count reached the bell tower. Bram pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Bram found a ledger half-buried near the bell tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Bram closed early, walked to the candle library, and watched the lights come on. Tinker followed at a distance.

Entry 6, winter of year 4

Phaedra visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Bram won 13 guilders from Wren on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on grandmother's cold buckwheat noodles. Bram won 31 guilders from Wren on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on grandmother's cold buckwheat noodles.

Entry 7, spring of year 4

At the Hall of Echoes, Bram taught Percival how to tell a real bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Bram found a bundle of letters half-buried near the Hall of Echoes and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Bram closed early, walked to the greenhouse cloisters, and watched the lights come on. Tinker followed at a distance. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 8, spring of year 4

Bram closed early, walked to the bell tower, and watched the lights come on. Tinker followed at a distance. Bram found a oilskin map half-buried near the north observatory and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a clockwork bird on the doorstep with no note. Bram suspects Percival and is probably right. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Bram found a cracked compass half-buried near the north observatory and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 9, summer of year 4

Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Bram suspects Percival and is probably right. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Bram suspects Percival and is probably right. Bram closed early, walked to the greenhouse cloisters, and watched the lights come on. Tinker followed at a distance.

Entry 10, autumn of year 4

the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the missing shipment. Bram read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Bram read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 11, summer of year 4

Juniper came by asking about the tariff on salt. Bram said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over the census flared up between Bram and Wren outside the bell tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Phaedra visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. Zeph came by asking about the tariff on salt. Bram said nothing useful and made tea instead. Phaedra visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 12, summer of year 4

Bram found a hand bell half-buried near the Hall of Echoes and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Phaedra visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. The weather turned. Bram moved the sextant indoors, fed Tinker, and wrote three lines to Phaedra about the old tunnels. The weather turned. Bram moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Tinker, and wrote three lines to Phaedra about the price of lamp oil.

Entry 13, autumn of year 5

Bram won 84 guilders from Wren on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on grandmother's cold buckwheat noodles. Bram closed early, walked to the bell tower, and watched the lights come on. Tinker followed at a distance. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 14, winter of year 5

A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Phaedra visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the greenhouse cloisters. Bram pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Bram found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the greenhouse cloisters and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Bram and Wren outside the greenhouse cloisters; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 15, spring of year 5

Bram spent the day counting stock at the Hall of Echoes: 89 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Benedikt came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Bram said nothing useful and made tea instead. Bram closed early, walked to the north observatory, and watched the lights come on. Tinker followed at a distance. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Bram and Wren outside the Hall of Echoes; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 16, winter of year 5

Bram won 28 guilders from Wren on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on grandmother's cold buckwheat noodles. Bram repaired the oilskin map at the greenhouse cloisters for Astrid, who paid in 49 guilders and a long story about who really won the regatta. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Bram found a bundle of letters half-buried near the greenhouse cloisters and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 17, summer of year 5

Bram closed early, walked to the north observatory, and watched the lights come on. Tinker followed at a distance. Bram closed early, walked to the north observatory, and watched the lights come on. Tinker followed at a distance. Phaedra visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Kenji came by asking about who really won the regatta. Bram said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 18, autumn of year 5

A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Bram and Wren outside the candle library; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the candle library, Bram taught Percival how to tell a real

bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. Phaedra visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a hand bell on the doorstep with no note. Bram suspects Percival and is probably right. Bram won 8 guilders from Wren on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on grandmother's cold buckwheat noodles.

Entry 19, winter of year 5

Bram was hired to carry a oilskin map from the candle library to the greenhouse cloisters without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Winifred came by asking about the tariff on salt. Bram said nothing useful and made tea instead. At the candle library, Bram taught Percival how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 20, autumn of year 5

Phaedra visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Bram won 73 guilders from Wren on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on grandmother's cold buckwheat noodles. Someone left a wax seal on the doorstep with no note. Bram suspects Percival and is probably right. Phaedra visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the bell tower. Bram pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.